

Cat Poop Refuses Litter Box — Action Checklist

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RULE OUT MEDICAL CAUSES

- ☐ **Rule Out Medical Causes:** Start a three-day poop journal documenting the time, location, stool consistency, and any straining behavior so you have concrete data to share with your vet.
- ☐ **Rule Out Medical Causes:** Examine your cat's stool in the litter box to check for hard, dry, small pellets that indicate constipation, which is the most common medical reason for poop avoidance.
- ☐ **Rule Out Medical Causes:** Watch your cat's posture in the litter box to see if she strains, gets in and out quickly without producing anything, or cries while trying to defecate.
- ☐ **Rule Out Medical Causes:** Feel your cat's belly for hardness or distension, which can indicate severe constipation requiring immediate veterinary attention within 48 hours.

PREPARE FOR THE VET VISIT

- ☐ **Prepare for the Vet Visit:** Bring your three-day poop journal with timestamps, stool consistency ratings, straining episodes, and accident locations to your veterinary appointment.
- ☐ **Prepare for the Vet Visit:** Photograph examples of normal versus hard, dry stools to show your vet the difference between healthy and concerning stool consistency.
- ☐ **Prepare for the Vet Visit:** Write down everything your cat eats daily including food brands and treats so your vet can evaluate whether diet is contributing to the problem.
- ☐ **Prepare for the Vet Visit:** Ask your vet specifically to test for IBD or chronic digestive inflammation rather than accepting a vague behavioral diagnosis without medical workup.

CHECK BOX SETUP FACTORS

- ☐ **Check Box Setup Factors:** Evaluate whether your litter box feels unsafe or uncomfortable for your cat, since she may be avoiding it specifically during the vulnerable act of defecation.
 - ☐ **Check Box Setup Factors:** Verify that your litter box is large enough for your cat to turn around comfortably without her rear end touching the sides or edge.
 - ☐ **Check Box Setup Factors:** Confirm you have at least one litter box per cat in your household placed in quiet, low-traffic areas away from noisy appliances or harsh lighting.
 - ☐ **Check Box Setup Factors:** Rule out that your cat had a past negative experience in the litter box, such as being startled, punished, or experiencing pain while using it for poop.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.